Lesson plan · for the teacher

# Check before you trust

AI · Level 1 · Lesson 4

**Time**
40 min

**Materials**
Board and chalk (or paper on the wall); Five statements on a slip: four true, one made up; Your pupils' textbook (and an atlas, if you have one); Worksheet: Fact detectives (one per pair, optional)

## Learning goals

- Explain that a chatbot can sound sure and still be wrong.
- Name ways to check a fact: a textbook, a teacher, a library or an elder.
- Use Ask → Check → Decide, and keep personal details private.

## Activity: Spot the made-up fact: Spot it

1. Warm-up (5 min): Ask: "A friend tells you something surprising. How do you find out if it's true?" List pupils' ideas on the board.
2. Teach (8 min): Explain that chatbots are computer programs — not robots — that write by guessing likely words. Draw a speech bubble with a question mark.
3. Spot it (12 min): Read the five statements in a confident 'robot' voice. Pupils vote for the made-up one with one to five fingers. Ask two pupils how they would check, then show the textbook page.
4. Pair talk (8 min): Write the three extra statements on the board. Pairs decide: true or made up? Where could they check, and who could they ask? Check one together.
5. Wrap-up (7 min): Write Ask → Check → Decide on the board. Add: never type your name, address, phone number or photo into a chatbot. Exit ticket: one fact and where to check it.

**Pick four true facts from your pupils' textbook and note each page. Write one false statement that sounds just as sure, such as "Bats are birds." Prepare three more statements for pair talk.**

## Discussion

- Does saying something confidently make it true?
- Which statement did I make up — and how could you check?
- Where could we check this, and who could we ask?

## Exit ticket

- One fact I learned today, and where I would check it.

**Try it in class tomorrow**
Play "Spot the made-up fact": Read five statements in a confident 'robot' voice — four from the textbook, one made up. Pupils vote for the fake, then say how they would check: textbook, teacher, library or an elder. Show the textbook page. Finish by writing Ask → Check → Decide on the board.

Worksheet · for pupils

# Check before you trust

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Name _____ Class _____ Date _____

**1** **Why can a chatbot give an answer that sounds sure but is wrong?**

- ◯ It predicts likely words instead of checking facts
- ◯ It is lying on purpose to trick you
- ◯ It only gets hard subjects wrong
- ◯ Its internet connection was too slow

**2** **If a chatbot sounds sure, it is probably right.**

- ◯ True
- ◯ False

**3** **Match each claim to a good place to check it.**

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| The date of a national exam | • • • • | Your science textbook |
| Which countries share Lake Victoria | • • • • | A library catalogue or librarian |
| How plants make their food | • • • • | The official exam timetable |
| A book the chatbot recommends | • • • • | An atlas |

**4** **Ask, check, decide — step by step. Put the steps in order.**

- ☐ Check key facts in a trusted source
- ☐ Mark the facts that matter most
- ☐ Decide what to keep, fix or drop
- ☐ Ask clearly, without pupils' details
- ☐ Read the whole answer carefully

**5** **Which parts of an AI answer should you check before you use them?**

- ☐ Health or safety advice
- ☐ Facts, numbers and dates
- ☐ Its friendly greeting
- ☐ How fluent its sentences sound
- ☐ Books, quotes or sources it names

Answers · for the teacher

# Check before you trust

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**1** **It predicts likely words instead of checking facts**

A chatbot learned how sentences sound, not which facts are true, so it predicts likely words and a fluent answer can still be false.

**2** **False**

Chatbots write fluently even when a fact is wrong.

**3** **The date of a national exam — The official exam timetable**
**Which countries share Lake Victoria — An atlas**
**How plants make their food — Your science textbook**
**A book the chatbot recommends — A library catalogue or librarian**

Each kind of claim has a trusted place to check it — a source whose job is to get that fact right.

**4** **Top to bottom: 4, 3, 5, 1, 2**

Ask, then check, then decide. Marking the key facts first keeps checking quick — you only look up what matters.

**5** **Facts, numbers and dates; Books, quotes or sources it names; Health or safety advice**

Check facts, numbers and dates: rare facts can't be worked out from patterns, so a chatbot may guess.

## For you to think about

**Think of one thing you might ask an AI tool for your class. What would you check before using the answer — and where?**